

097 Build a log-pile home

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MINS

Rotting wood is important for wildlife, and there is a lot going on in a log pile. It provides food for many animals and insects, and some animals hibernate there in winter. Once built, don't disturb a log pile.

What you need

- Shovel
- Logs and sticks
- Bark, leaves, and ivy plants



1 Pick a shady corner that's out of the way—dappled shade is best. Dig a shallow pit. Pile up the logs, the biggest at the bottom.



2 Put the smaller sticks on top, crisscrossing them as you go. Fill any spaces with leaves, bark, pinecones, or stones.



3 Plant an ivy vine and trail it across the top of the pile to help keep in moisture. Your log pile will now make a warm, safe home for small creatures.

Lichens, mosses, and fungi also grow on log piles and provide food for bugs.

098 Make a maze for woodlice

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MINS

Use building bricks to make a maze that has a T-junction. Put in some woodlice and let them wander around. Add a brick to make them turn right, then let them choose. Most will turn to the left!

Building bricks

Woodlouse

